

NIMA SHAHBAZI

San Francisco Bay Area, CA

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RESEARCH INTEREST

Data preparation, data management, data centric AI, algorithmic fairness, responsible AI, algorithmic databases and data mining.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Computer Science, University of Illinois Chicago <i>advisor:</i> Dr. Abolfazl Asudeh	2020 - 2025
M.Sc. in Computer Science, The University of Texas at Dallas	2018 - 2020
B.E. in Computer Engineering, University of Isfahan	2008 - 2013

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Scientist, Megagon Labs	Nov 2025 - Present
Research Intern, Microsoft Research, Gray Systems Lab	May 2025 - Aug 2025
Research/Teaching Assistant, University of Illinois Chicago	2020 - 2025
Research Scientist Intern, Megagon Labs	May 2023 - Aug 2023
Teaching Assistant The University of Texas at Dallas	2018 - 2020

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Nima Shahbazi**, Abolfazl Asudeh, Stavros Sintos “Fair Count-Min: Frequency Estimation under Equal Group-wise Approximation Factor”, in *SIGMOD 2026*.
2. **Nima Shahbazi**, Aryan Esmailpour, Stavros Sintos “Weighted Set Multi-Cover on Bounded Universe and Applications in Package Recommendations”, in *SIGMOD 2026*.
3. **Nima Shahbazi** and Abolfazl Asudeh “Reliability Evaluation of Individual Predictions: A Data-centric Approach”, in *VLDB Journal 2024*.
4. **Nima Shahbazi**, Mahdi Erfanian and Abolfazl Asudeh “Coverage-based Data-centric Approaches for Responsible and Trustworthy AI”, in *IEEE Data Engineering Bulletin 2024*.
5. **Nima Shahbazi**, Mahdi Erfanian, Abolfazl Asudeh, Fatemeh Nargesian, and Divesh Srivastava “FairEM360: A Suite for Responsible Entity Matching”, in *VLDB 2024*
6. Sana Ebrahimi, **Nima Shahbazi** and Abolfazl Asudeh “REALM: Reliability and Equity through Aggregation in Large Language Models”, in *NAACL Findings 2024*.
7. **Nima Shahbazi**, Jin Wang, Zhengjie Miao and Nikita Bhutani “Fairness-aware Data Preparation for Entity Matching”, in *ICDE 2024*.
8. **Nima Shahbazi**, Stavros Sintos and Abolfazl Asudeh “FairHash: A Fair and Memory/Time-efficient Hash Map”, in *SIGMOD 2024*.
9. Melika Mousavi, **Nima Shahbazi** and Abolfazl Asudeh “Crowdsourcing Representation Bias Identification in form of Data Coverage in Image Data Sets”, in *EDBT 2024*.
10. Khanh Duy Nguyen, **Nima Shahbazi** and Abolfazl Asudeh “PopSim: Individual-level Population Simulation for Equitable Allocation of City Resources”, in *AFair-AMLD 2024*.
11. **Nima Shahbazi**, Nikola Danevski, Fatemeh Nargesian, Abolfazl Asudeh and Divesh Srivastava “Through the Fairness Lens: Experimental Analysis and Evaluation of Entity Matching”, in *VLDB 2023*.
12. **Nima Shahbazi**, Yin Lin, Abolfazl Asudeh and H.V. Jagadish “Representation Bias in Data: A Survey on Identification and Resolution Techniques”, in *ACM Computing Surveys 2023*.

13. Hantian Zhang, **Nima Shahbazi**, Xu Chu and Abolfazl Asudeh “FairRover: Explorative Model Building for Fair and Responsible Machine Learning”, in *DEEM 2021*.
14. Abolfazl Asudeh, **Nima Shahbazi**, Zhongjun Jin and H.V. Jagadish “Identifying Insufficient Data Coverage for Ordinal Continuous-Valued Attributes”, in *SIGMOD 2021*.

SKILLS

Programming: Python, Java, C++, SQL, Full-stack Web Development

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

- Reviewer at *TKDE* Journal 2025
- PC member at *CIKM'25* 2025
- External reviewer at *ICDE'25* 2025
- Reviewer at *TKDE* Journal 2024
- PC member at *CIKM'24* 2024
- Reviewer at *TKDD'24* 2024
- ARI reviewer at *SIGMOD'24* 2023
- ARI reviewer at *SIGMOD'23* 2022
- External reviewer at *ICDE'23* 2022
- Reviewer at *Information Systems* journal 2021
- Mentored 4 students for their senior/master’s thesis at University of Illinois Chicago 2021-present
- Student volunteer at *VLDB'20* 2020

HONORS AND AWARDS

- UIC College of Engineering Exceptional Research Promise Award 2024-2025
- Collaborator on NSF-funded project (IIS-2348919): Fairness-aware Data Structures for Approximate Query Processing, contributing to a successful proposal that secured \$499,999 in funding, alongside PIs Abolfazl Asudeh and Stavros Sintos.
- Ranked top 2% in the Iranian university entrance exam. 2008